

Mojo

Palm has launched a Mojo Software Development Kit (SDK) beta which will be available free to any and all interested app developers and is based on the standard app development HTML, CSS, and Javascript.

Going green

Greenpeace is on the prowl over its next target – Dell. The fuss over here is about Dell's recycling service which is not easily found on its web site.

Feature



But, how can I just trust any version of Linux to download, I mean since the source code is open to all, how do I know someone has not modified it to put in a trojan or something?

Well there have been many arguments about the risks of open source and how by distributing the source code itself, you give the evil-minded people a chance to create havoc. At the same time, a closed source project is prone to a similar case, but in this case the evil-minded person could be, for example, a disgruntled and frustrated employee.



So what about the viruses and worms running around in cyber space? Won't I get attacked if I'm using Linux?



Actually you won't. Permissions work differently in Linux, you are not always logged in as the Administrator, or in Linux – Root, so there is a smaller chance to install any malicious software on your PC. On top of that, the viruses being created are more Windows-oriented and even with the current anti-virus applications available for Linux, they all mostly scan for Windows-based viruses which don't even affect Linux users.



I guess I am seeing the bigger picture about open source here, but seriously, the one major problem I see with open source is gaming. I need some time to play games, and I'm sure many others also want some games in their life, and I'm not talking about something like Minesweeper or Solitaire or even those web sites with flash-based games. How am I supposed to play Counter Strike, for instance, if I am running a Linux distribution?

That is a tough one, but can I offer you Quake 3 Arena instead? You're right about one thing, that not all games are able to run on Linux systems. But at the same time, there are a few good Linux titles out there. As mentioned earlier, Quake 3 is one of them. There are MMORPGs such as Second Life and Vendetta Online that one could try out too, and don't forget America's Army, that works well on Linux too.



Yes, fine, there are alternatives, but what about Counter Strike or even Crysis?

Fine, you got me stumped on that for now. But it won't be too long before these games will be working on any PC in the world, be it Mac, Windows or Linux. This is all thanks to the upcoming virtual gaming concept such as On Live, where all the hardware is taken care of. Think of it as cloud gaming. I'm sure you've already heard of Quake Live, that's a good example of what I'm talking about. So there, it's not going to be too long before everybody can game on an equal level, no matter what hardware is present.



Yea, yea, there's still time for that. But you have changed the view I had about open source in general though, maybe I'll try it out.

Don't rush into it though, you could always start off with something small, like say Open Office which is the open source equivalent to MS Office. You will see changes, but I'm sure it's nothing you can't handle. Maybe from there you could move on to Ubuntu or Linux Mint. 



THE BAD SIDE OF OPEN SOURCE

We aren't talking about the drawbacks of open source here, but instead we are talking about how the whole concept of open source can be used for evil. The way open source works is that the source code of an application or project is distributed freely in such a way that others can modify and reuse it. But what happens when this is done by the villains, in this case hackers or script-kiddies? Hackers have not only been spreading viruses and other malicious threats, but in fact have been also spreading

the whole recipe of how to create them. It all comes down to programming, and once the code is freely distributed, along with instructions on how to use it, there's no stopping them. There are even communities based around this sort of open source activities where people discuss building new internet threats together. These communities are still present on various IRC channels, but don't expect to join such groups in an instant, as they aren't as easy as joining a community on Facebook.